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REPORT | JANUARY 25, 2024

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Americans More Upbeat on the Economy; Biden's Job Rating Remains Very Low

In their own words: How people feel about the economy

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How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand how the public views Joe Biden and the economy at the start of the new year. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16-21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for the report and its methodology.

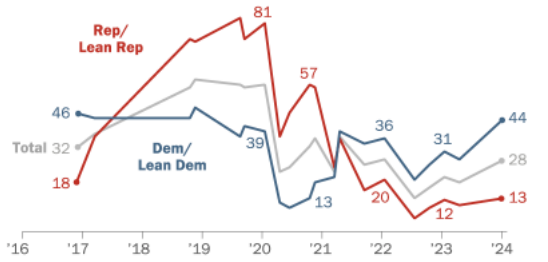
Americans' views of the nation's economy – while mostly stagnant for the past few years – are showing signs of improvement. Slightly more than a quarter (28%) rate economic conditions as excellent or good, a 9 percentage point increase from last April.

Virtually all the change since then has come among Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents. Currently, 44% of Democrats have positive views of the economy – the highest share of Joe Biden's presidency.

The new survey by Pew Research Center, conducted Jan. 16-21 among 5,140 adults, finds

Positive views of the nation's economy increase, driven by Democrats

*% who say economic conditions in this country today are **excellent or good***



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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REPORT MATERIALS

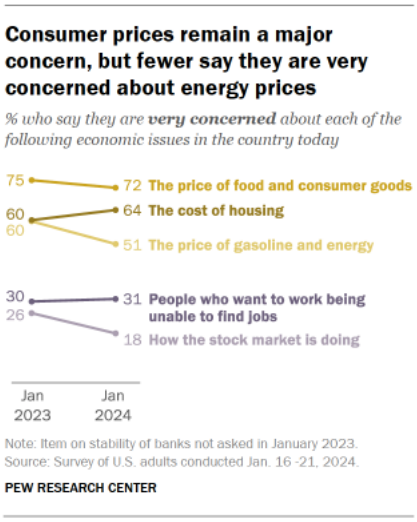
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that Biden's own job rating remains highly negative: Just 33% of Americans approve of his job performance, unchanged from last month.

The economy, past and future; top concerns

Despite the improvement in economic attitudes, the public is far less upbeat today than it was from 2018 through early 2020, during Donald Trump's presidency and prior to the outbreak of the coronavirus pandemic.

Economic ratings remain far less positive than before the pandemic. In January 2020, 57% of Americans rated economic conditions as excellent or good; positive ratings fell to 23% in April of that year, as the coronavirus outbreak spread across the country. Views of the economy improved early during Biden's first few months in office but declined subsequently.



The public's future economic outlook turns less negative. The share of Americans saying economic conditions will be worse a year from now has fallen from 46% last April to 33% today.

However, more continue to say that conditions will be *worse* than *better* (26%) next year; 41% expect the economy will be about the same as it is today.

There's less concern about energy prices and the stock market. A sizable majority of Americans (72%) say they are very concerned about prices for food and consumer goods, little changed from last year. The cost of housing also is a major issue, with 64% very concerned.

However, the shares expressing a great deal of concern about prices of gasoline and energy and how the stock market is doing have declined 9 points and 8 points, respectively, since last January.

In their own words: Americans on the economy

When the majority of Americans who rate economic conditions poor or only fair are asked *why* they feel this way, most point to inflation or high prices. Nearly half (45%) specifically mention high inflation (28%) or the high cost of living (21%); 11% specifically point to the high cost of food and groceries or the cost of housing.

People who view the economy positively – those who rate conditions as excellent or good – most often say low unemployment is a major reason why they feel the way they do (43% say this). Other factors cited are that inflation has come down (18%), wage growth (10%), or the strong performance of the stock market (9%).

Biden's job performance, personal traits

Currently, 33% of Americans approve of Joe Biden's job performance, while 65% disapprove. Biden's job rating has not been above 40% since April 2022.

Young adults are negative about Biden's job performance. Biden's job rating is low across all age groups, including young adults. Just 27% of adults ages 18 to 29 approve of the way Biden is handling his job as president, while 71% disapprove.

Black adults are divided over Biden. About as many Black adults disapprove (49%) as approve (48%) of Biden's job performance. Biden's job rating is lower among Asian (39%), Hispanic (32%) and White (30%) adults.

Views of Biden's personal traits have grown less positive. Biden gets his most positive ratings for being even-tempered (62% say this phrase describes him very or fairly well) and standing up for what he believes in (50%).

Why do Americans rate the economy the way they do?

Why did you rate national economic conditions the way you did? (%) [open-end]

Among those who say conditions are excellent/good (28% of adults)	%	Among those who say conditions are only fair/poor (72% of adults)	%
Low unemployment	43	High inflation	28
Inflation is down	18	High cost of living	21
Wage growth	10	Lack of good paying jobs/ Wages low	15
Positive mentions of stock market	9	National debt	7
U.S. outperforming expectations	5	High cost of food and groceries	6
		High cost of housing	6
		High interest rates	6
		Negative mentions of Biden/Democrats	6
		Illegal Immigration	5
		Wealth inequality	5

Note: Researchers coded up to three responses. Only responses that made up 5% or more of responses are shown here. Refer to topline for full question wording and response list.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Far fewer Americans describe him as mentally sharp (29%), inspiring (26%) or energetic (24%). For the most part, perceptions of Biden's personal traits have followed the same downward trajectory as his job ratings.

Judgments on Biden's legacy

The share of Americans saying that Biden will be an unsuccessful president in the long run has increased steadily over the course of his administration.

Currently, 55% say he will be an unsuccessful president while just 23% say he will be successful; 20% say it is too early to tell. These opinions, like other views of Biden, are deeply partisan: Republicans overwhelmingly say Biden will be unsuccessful (87%).

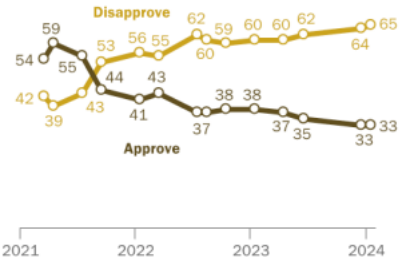
Among Democrats, 45% say he will be successful, 26% say unsuccessful, and 28% say it is too early to tell.

Other findings on partisan compromise and the House GOP impeachment inquiry

A majority of Democrats (59%) say Biden should try his best to work with GOP leaders to accomplish things, even if that disappoints some of his voters; only 32% of Republicans say the same of GOP leaders trying to reach compromises with

By nearly 2 to 1, Americans disapprove of Biden's job performance

% who say they ___ of the way Joe Biden is handling his job as president

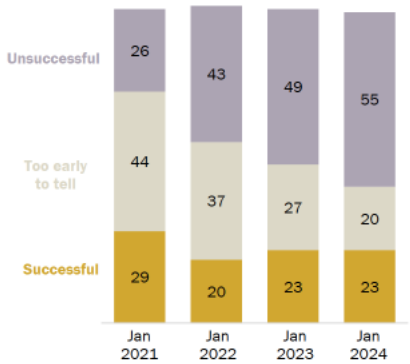


Note: No answer responses are not shown
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Growing share of Americans say Biden ultimately will be an unsuccessful president

% who say Biden will be a(n) ___ president in the long run

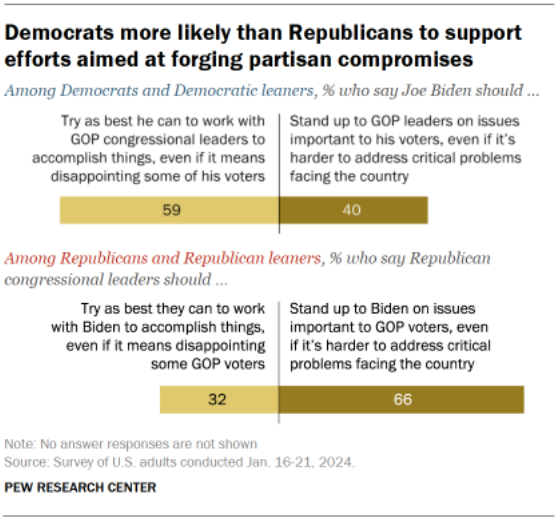


Note: No answer responses are not shown
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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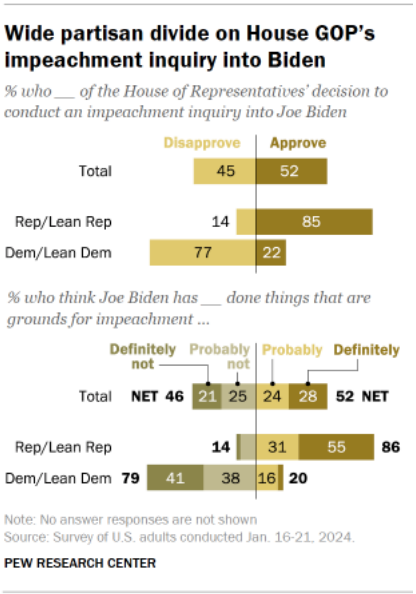
Biden. These opinions have changed little over the course of Biden's presidency.

During the Trump administration, Democrats were less likely to say their party's leaders should seek compromise with Trump than Republicans were to say their party should try to seek political compromise with Democratic leaders.



About half of Americans (52%) approve of House Republicans' decision to conduct an impeachment inquiry into Joe Biden, while 45% disapprove. These opinions – and views about whether Biden has done anything that is grounds for his impeachment – are deeply divided along partisan lines: 85% of Republicans approve of the inquiry, while 77% of Democrats disapprove.

Relatively few Americans (16%) say they are following news about the impeachment inquiry launched by House Republicans into Biden's conduct and possible connections to his son Hunter's business dealings extremely or very closely.



Next: Views of the nation's economy

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2. Biden's job rating, personal traits and whether he will be a successful president

Acknowledgments

Methodology

SHORT READS | JANUARY 29, 2024

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New Year's resolutions: Who makes them and why

BY SHANAY GRACIA



A jogger in Payson Park in Portland, Maine, on Jan. 2, 2022. (Derek Davis/Portland Press Herald via Getty Images)

It's the time of year when New Year's resolutions are made – and sometimes broken.

Three-in-ten Americans report making at least one resolution this year, with half of this group making more than one, according to a new Pew Research Center survey.

Nearly a month into the new year, the survey also finds that most people who made resolutions have stuck with them, although 13% say they have not kept any of them.

Here are some key facts about the Americans who make New Year's resolutions and why they make them, based on the survey of adults conducted Jan. 16-21.

How we did this

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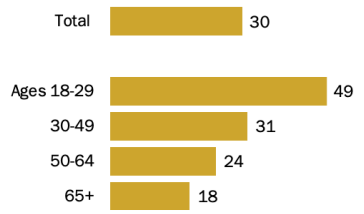
Lifestyle

MOST POPULAR

Pew Research Center included these questions about New Year's resolutions as part of a larger survey on Americans' views of the country at the start of the new year. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

New Year's resolutions are more popular among young people than older adults

% who say they made at least one New Year's resolution this year



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.
PEW RESEARCH CENTER

Here are the questions used for the analysis and its methodology.

Young adults are most likely to make New Year's resolutions

Nearly half (49%) of adults ages 18 to 29 say they made at least one resolution this year, by far the largest share of any age group.

About a third (31%) of those ages 30 to 49 say they made a resolution, while only about a fifth (21%) of adults 50 and older have done so.

There are only modest differences in who makes resolutions by race or ethnicity, gender or partisanship.

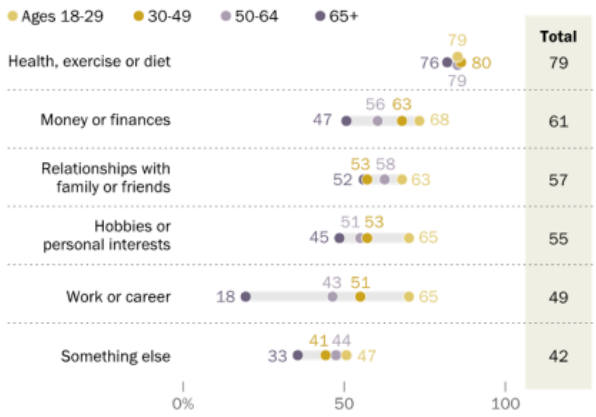
Health and wealth are popular topics for New Year's resolutions

Across all age groups, sizable majorities of those who made resolutions this year say their goals focus on health, exercise or diet.

Overall, 79% say their resolutions concern health. Smaller but still sizable shares made resolutions about money or finances (61%), personal relationships (57%), hobbies or personal interests (55%), or work and career (49%).

A large majority of New Year's resolutions focus on health, exercise or diet

Among those who made at least one New Year's resolution this year, % who say they made a resolution about ...



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.
PEW RESEARCH CENTER

Younger Americans are more likely than older Americans to make resolutions about each of these topics, apart from health. This is especially the case for work and career: 65% of those under age 30 who made resolutions say they made one related to their work or career. This is by far the largest share of any age group.

1 Americans are split over the state of the American dream

2 Majorities of LGBTQ and non-LGBTQ U.S. adults under 50 want to get married someday

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Some Americans are early backsliders on their New Year's resolutions

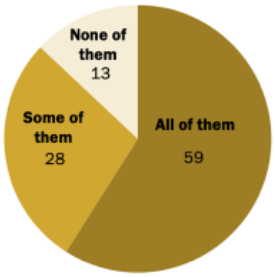
Less than a month into the new year, a large majority of those who made resolutions (87%) say they have kept at least some of them.

About six-in-ten adults who made at least one resolution (59%) say they have kept *all* of them so far, while 28% say they have kept *some* of them. Another 13% say they have kept *none* of them.

There are only modest demographic differences when it comes to who has broken resolutions and who has stuck with them so far.

Most Americans who have made resolutions have kept them ... so far

Among those who made at least one New Year's resolution, % who say they have kept ...



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Many Americans just don't like making New Year's resolutions

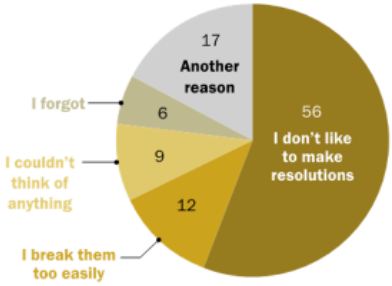
Of the 70% of Americans who *did not* make any New Year's resolutions this year, a majority (56%) say their main reason for not doing so is they simply do not like to make resolutions.

About one-in-ten (12%) of those who didn't make a resolution say they break them too easily. Nearly as many (9%) say they couldn't think of a resolution to make, while 6% say they forgot to make one this year. Another 17% say they have another reason for making no resolutions.

Note: Here are the questions used for the analysis and its methodology.

Why many Americans don't make New Year's resolutions

*Among those who **did not** make a New Year's resolution this year, % who say ____ is the main reason they did not make a resolution*



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Topics Leisure, Lifestyle

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SHORT READS | JANUARY 31, 2024

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Most Americans say elected officials should avoid heated or aggressive speech

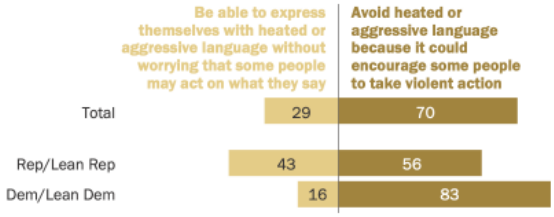
BY TED VAN GREEN

Seven-in-ten Americans say elected officials should avoid heated or aggressive language because it could encourage some people to take violent action. By contrast, 29% say officials should be able to use heated language without worrying about how some people may act.

There are sizable partisan differences in these opinions, with Democrats more likely than Republicans to say elected officials should avoid heated language.

Majorities in both parties – though more Democrats than Republicans – say elected officials should avoid heated or aggressive language

% who say elected officials should ...



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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A narrow majority of Republicans and Republican-leaning independents (56%) say elected officials should avoid heated or aggressive language, while 43% say officials should be able to express themselves with this kind of language without worrying about whether people may act on what they say. Republicans today are more likely than in 2019 to see the use of heated or aggressive language by elected officials as acceptable: In 2019, 37% said officials should be able to use this kind of language.

By contrast, **the vast majority of Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents (83%) say elected officials should avoid using heated language**, while 16% say officials should be able to use this kind of language without worrying about how some people might act. There has been no change in views among Democrats since 2019.

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MOST POPULAR

How we did this ⊖

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand how the public views the use of heated or aggressive language by elected officials and political candidates. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for the report and its methodology.

In addition to the wide partisan gap on this question, there are some notable demographic differences, according to a new survey by Pew Research Center, conducted Jan. 16-21 among 5,140 adults:

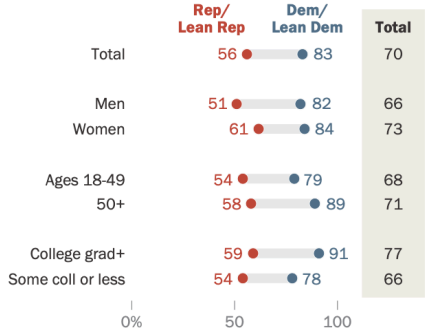
Gender

Women are 7 percentage points more likely than men to say elected officials should avoid heated language (73% vs. 66%). This overall gender gap is driven primarily by differences among Republicans.

- 61% of Republican women say elected officials should avoid heated language, compared with 51% of GOP men.
- Democratic women and men do not differ substantially on this question.

Within each party, there are relatively modest differences in whether elected officials should avoid heated language

*% who say elected officials **should avoid heated or aggressive language** because it could encourage some people to take violent action*



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Age

At least two-thirds of U.S. adults in all age groups say elected officials should avoid heated language. But there are some modest age differences within partisan groups, particularly among Democrats.

- Democrats ages 50 and older are more likely than those under 50 to say elected officials should avoid heated language (89% vs. 79%).
- 54% of Republicans under 50 and 58% of those ages 50 and older say elected officials should avoid using heated language.

Education

Adults who have at least a bachelor's degree are more likely than those with less formal education to say elected officials should avoid the use of heated or aggressive language because it could encourage violence (77% vs. 66%). This pattern holds more among Democrats than Republicans.

- 91% of Democrats with at least a college degree say elected officials should avoid heated language, compared with 78% of Democrats who do not have a bachelor's degree.
- Among Republicans, there is little difference on this question by education.

Do views differ when asked about 'political candidates' rather than 'elected officials'?

1 Americans are split over the state of the American dream

2 Majorities of LGBTQ and non-LGBTQ U.S. adults under 50 want to get married someday

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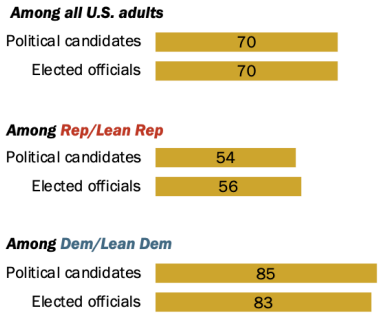
Americans hold nearly identical views about the acceptability of "political candidates" using heated or aggressive language and the acceptability of "elected officials" doing so.

The same is true among partisans: Slim majorities of Republicans say political candidates (54%) and elected officials (56%) should not use heated language. And nearly identical shares of Democrats say political candidates (85%) and elected officials (83%) should avoid heated language.

Note: Here are the questions used for the report and its methodology.

No difference in views of how 'political candidates' versus 'elected officials' should approach heated language

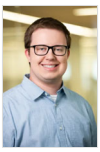
% who say ___ should avoid heated or aggressive language because it could encourage some people to take violent action



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.
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Topics Political Animosity, Political Discourse, Political Parties & Polarization, Politics & Policy

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REPORT | FEBRUARY 1, 2024

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From Businesses and Banks to Colleges and Churches: Americans' Views of U.S. Institutions

Continued partisan divides on schools, unions, churches

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How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to examine Americans' views of different national institutions. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 U.S. adults from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for this report, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

Americans overwhelmingly see small businesses as having a positive effect on the way things are going in the country.

By contrast, their views of large corporations are broadly negative. Most people – including identical shares in both parties – also are critical of the impact of banks and financial institutions.

A new national survey conducted by Pew Research Center from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21 among 5,140 adults also finds:

The **U.S. military** is viewed positively by 60% of Americans, and these views are similar across most demographic and political groups.

There are wide partisan divides on the impact of **educational institutions**, both K-12 public schools and colleges and universities:

- About three-quarters of Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents view **colleges and universities** positively, but only about three-in-ten Republicans and Republican leaners give these institutions positive marks. The partisan divide on **K-12 public schools** is about as wide.

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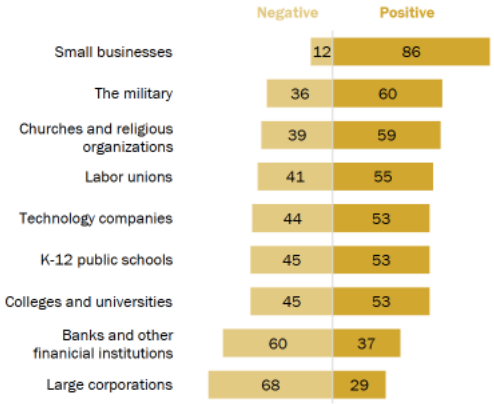
American Trends Panel Wave 140

Churches and religious organizations are viewed positively by about six-in-ten Americans, but there are sizeable differences in these views between Republicans and Democrats, as well as between the religiously affiliated and the religiously unaffiliated:

- Nearly three-quarters of Republicans (73%) say churches and religious institutions have a positive impact. Democrats' opinions are more divided: 45% say their effect is positive, 53% say it is negative.
- And while religiously affiliated Americans generally rate the impact of organized religion positively, the views of unaffiliated Americans are more negative.

Most Americans say small businesses have a positive impact; large corporations, banks viewed negatively

% who say each of the following has a ____ effect on the way things are going in the country these days



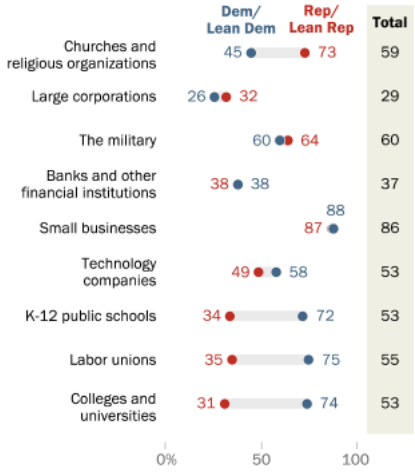
Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.
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Views of the effect of **labor unions** also differ considerably by party:

- Three-quarters of Democrats, compared with just 35% of Republicans, say unions have a positive impact on how things are going in the United States these days.

Wide partisan differences in views of churches, schools and labor unions

*% who say each of the following has a **positive** effect on the way things are going in the country these days*



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.
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Explore more detailed looks at demographic and political differences in Americans' views of the impact of each of these institutions:

- **Educational institutions:** Colleges and universities, K-12 public schools
- **Business:** Small and large businesses, banks, and technology companies
- **Labor unions**
- **Churches and religious organizations**
- **The U.S. military**

Next: Colleges and universities, K-12 public schools

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5. The U.S. military

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REPORT | FEBRUARY 7, 2024

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Bipartisan Support for Early In-Person Voting, Voter ID, Election Day National Holiday

Widening partisan divides over vote-by-mail and registration policies

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Voters take part in the Democratic primary at the Cordesville, South Carolina, fire department on Feb. 3. (Brandon Bell/Getty Images)

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand Americans' views of voting policies and procedures in the United States. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16-21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for the report and its methodology.

Americans generally believe that voting is an effective way to bring about positive change in the country. But in recent years, there have been contentious debates in a number of

REPORT MATERIALS

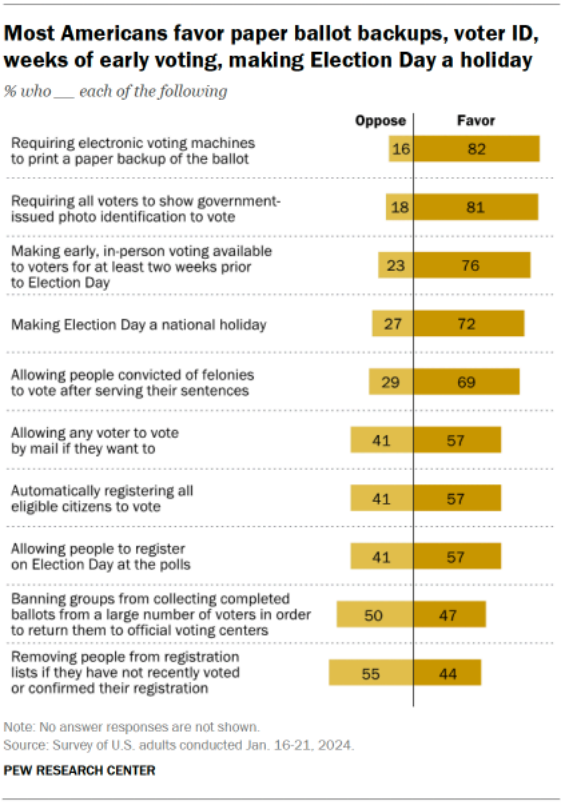
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states over the rules around voting and elections.

A new national survey finds deep partisan divisions over some voting policies, especially voting by mail.

Yet other proposals draw widespread public support, including from majorities in both partisan coalitions:

- Requiring paper ballot backups for electronic voting machines (82% favor this),
- Requiring people to show government-issued photo identification to vote (81%),
- Making early voting available for two weeks prior to Election Day (76%),
- Making Election Day a national holiday (72%) and
- Allowing convicted felons to vote after serving their sentences (69%).



The Pew Research Center survey, conducted Jan. 16-21 among 5,140 adults, also finds smaller majorities supporting allowing anyone to vote by mail if they want to (57%), as well as automatic and Election Day voter registration (57% each).

Americans are more divided on whether groups should be banned from collecting completed ballots to return to official voting centers (47% favor, 50% oppose) and whether people should be removed from registration lists if they have not voted recently or confirmed their registration (44% favor, 55% oppose).

Proposals with broad bipartisan support

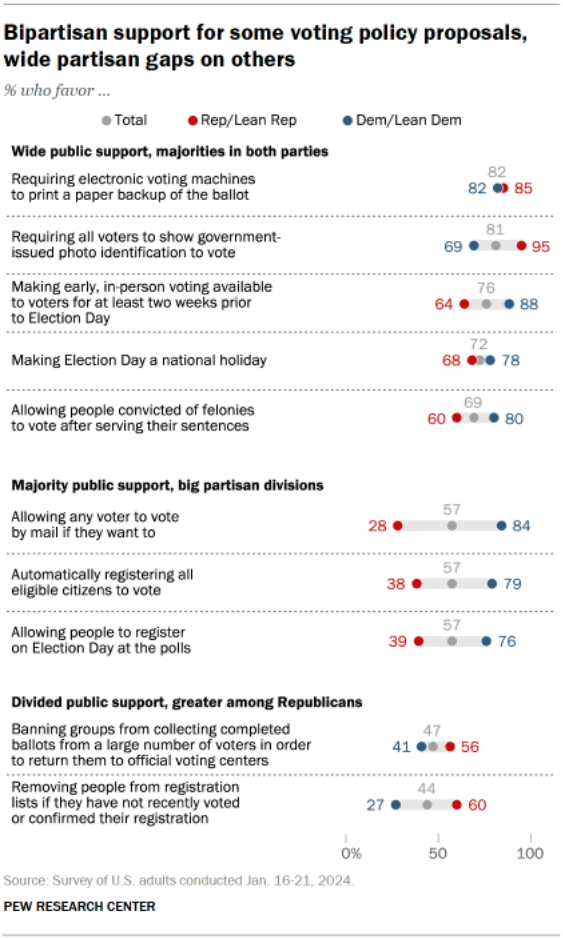
More than eight-in-ten Republicans and those who lean to the Republican Party (85%), and a similar share of Democrats and Democratic leaners (82%), favor paper ballot backups for electronic voting machines.

While there is substantial support in both parties for requiring a photo ID to vote, there is a sizable partisan divide in these views: Nearly all Republicans (95%), compared with 69% of Democrats, favor this requirement.

At least six-in-ten among both parties also favor allowing two weeks of early in-person voting, making Election Day a national holiday and allowing convicted felons to vote after serving their sentences. Yet support for each of these policies is higher among Democrats than Republicans.

Proposals with narrow majority public support, and wide partisan differences

About six-in-ten adults (57% each) support allowing anyone to vote by mail if they want, automatically registering eligible citizens to vote and allowing registration on Election Day.



However, Democrats are far more supportive of these proposals than Republicans. At least three-quarters of Democrats support each of them, while there is more opposition than support for them among Republicans.

Proposals that divide the public

Nearly half of Americans (47%) favor banning groups from collecting completed ballots to return to official voting centers, while roughly the same share (50%) oppose this. The public is also relatively divided over removing people from voter registration lists if they have not voted recently or confirmed their registration, with slightly more opposing this (55%) than supporting it (44%).

Republicans are about twice as likely as Democrats (60% vs. 27%) to support the removal of inactive records from registration lists. Republicans are also more likely than Democrats (56% vs. 41%) to favor banning groups from collecting and returning ballots.

Shifts in support for some election policy proposals

Support for – and opposition to – many election policy proposals is similar to views in recent years, though there have been some notable shifts.

Election Day policies

Americans have long supported **making Election Day a national holiday.** But support for this has risen in recent years, from 65% in 2018 to 72% today. Currently, 78% of Democrats and 68% of Republicans favor this.

By contrast, support for **allowing Election Day voter registration** has dropped over the last several years –from 64% in 2018 to 57% now.

- This decrease is largely driven by declining support among Republicans: 39% currently favor Election Day voter registration, down from 49% four years ago.
- 76% of Democrats favor allowing Election Day registration, little different from the 78% who said this in 2018.

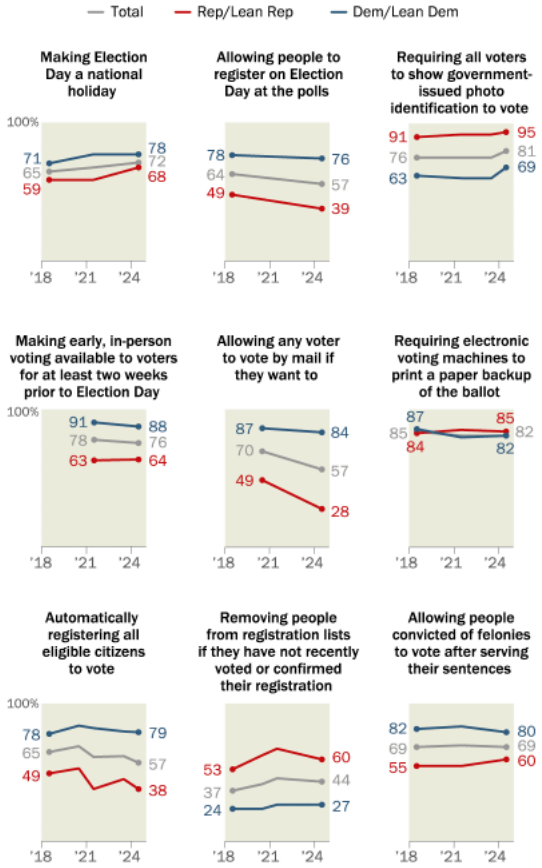
Voting by mail

The single widest partisan gap on the voting policies asked about in this survey is over "allowing any voter to vote by mail if they want to." And that gap is now substantially wider than it was in April 2020, the result of a sharp decline in support among Republicans:

- Today, just 28% of Republicans say any voter should be allowed to vote by mail if they want to. Four years ago, 49% of Republicans said this.
- An overwhelming share of Democrats (84%) continue to say voting by mail should be available to all voters. Democratic support is essentially unchanged over this period.

Partisans grow further apart on automatic and Election Day voter registration, voting by mail

% who favor ...



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Voter ID

Majorities in both parties continue to back requiring all voters to show government-issued photo ID to vote.

- The share of Democrats supporting this has risen from 61% to 69% since last year.
- Support for voter ID remains nearly universal among Republicans (95% favor).

Age differences on voter registration policies

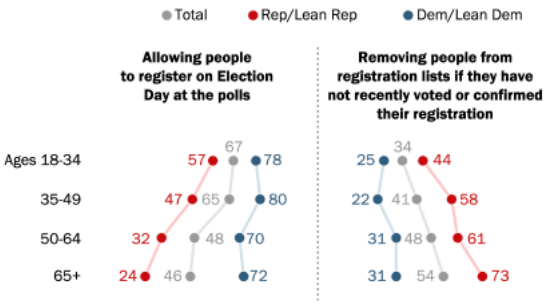
While there are only modest age differences on many of the voting policies asked about in the survey, there are wider gaps on two policies related to voter registration.

Older adults are far less supportive than younger adults of same-day voter registration. They are also more supportive of removing people from registration lists if they have not voted recently.

These differences are particularly pronounced among Republicans.

Wide age gaps, especially within GOP, on same-day registration and removal of inactive voter records

% who favor ...



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Election Day registration

- About six-in-ten Republicans ages 18 to 34 (57%) favor same-day voter registration. The share backing this drops among older age groups. Just 24% of Republicans ages 65 and older support allowing Election Day registration.
- There are only modest age differences on this question among Democrats, with about seven-in-ten of those 50 and older supporting same-day voter registration, along with about eight-in-ten of those under 50.

Removing inactive registration records

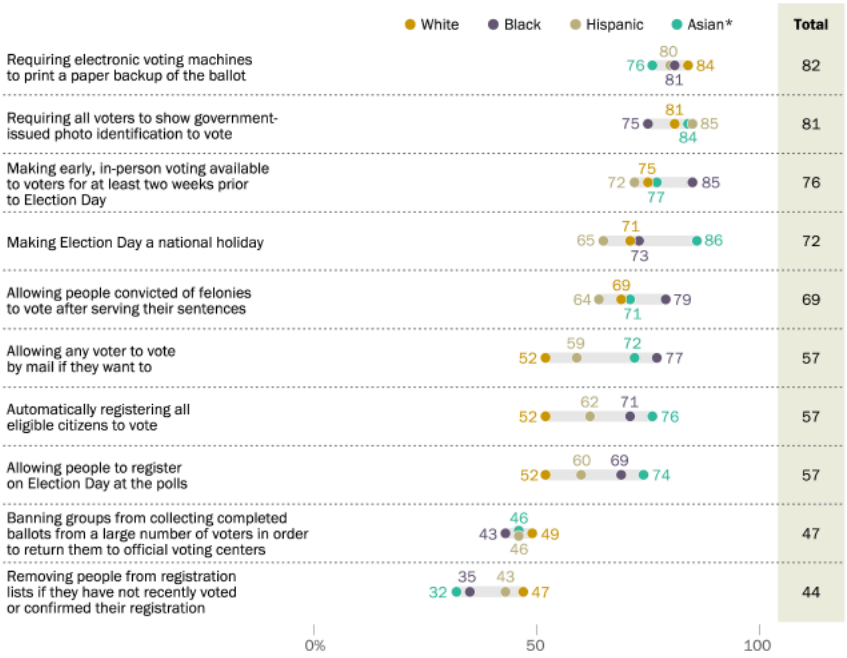
- Nearly three-quarters of Republicans ages 65 and older (73%) support removing people from registration lists if they have not recently voted or confirmed their registration, as do 61% of Republicans 50 to 64 and 58% of Republicans 35 to 49. Republicans ages 18 to 34 are less likely (44%) to say this.
- Among Democrats, age differences are far more modest: 24% of those under 50 and 31% of those 50 and older favor the removal of registration records for inactivity.

Views of voting proposals among racial and ethnic groups

Across racial and ethnic groups, large majorities favor requiring paper ballot backups for electronic voting machines, photo ID requirements for voting and making Election Day a national holiday.

White Americans are less supportive of allowing anyone to vote by mail if they want to, automatic voter registration and same-day registration

% who favor ...



* Estimates for Asian adults are representative of English speakers only.
Note: White, Black and Asian adults include only those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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- Majorities also favor allowing two weeks of early in-person voting and allowing convicted felons to vote after serving their sentences, with Black adults more likely than any other group to *strongly* favor these policies.
- While about half of White adults (52%) favor policy proposals that would allow anyone to vote by mail if they want, automatically register all citizens to vote, or allow people to register on Election Day, they are far less supportive of these policies than other racial and ethnic groups. About three-quarters of Asian adults favor these policies, as do similar shares of Black adults and about six-in-ten Hispanic adults.

Views of election policies across ideological groups

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Bipartisan Support for Early In-Person Voting, Voter ID, Election Day National Holiday

Shifts in support for some election policy proposals

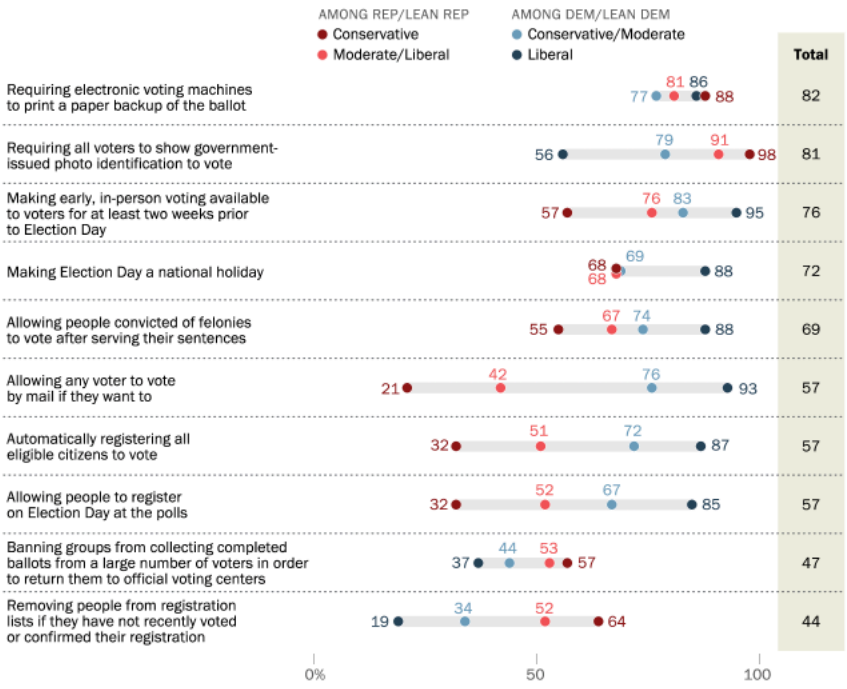
Age differences on voter registration policies

For the most part, partisan and ideological differences in support or opposition to voting policies find wide gaps between liberal Democrats and conservative Republicans, with moderates in both parties falling somewhere in between. But there are a few exceptions:

- Liberal Democrats are particularly likely to support making Election Day a national holiday. But there is no gap in opinion between other groups: 88% of liberals favor this, compared with about seven-in-ten of those in other ideological groups.
- Wide majorities across all groups favor requiring paper backup ballots – with nearly identical shares of conservative Republicans (88%) and liberal Democrats (86%) saying this.

Substantial ideological differences within both parties on some election policies

% who favor ...



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Next: Acknowledgments

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Views of election policies across ideological groups

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SHORT READS | FEBRUARY 12, 2024

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Most Americans continue to say their side in politics is losing more often than it is winning

BY TED VAN GREEN

As the 2024 presidential campaign heats up, most Americans (71%) say that, on the issues that matter to them, their side in politics has been losing more often than winning. Just a quarter say their side has been winning more often than losing.

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this analysis as part of our ongoing research into how Americans feel about current politics. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16 to 21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for this analysis and its methodology.

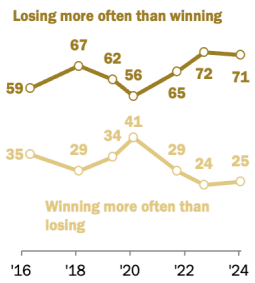
- This is not a new sentiment. Since 2016, a majority of U.S. adults have expressed the view that their side is losing more often than winning.
- The share of adults who say their side is losing more often than winning is up 15 percentage points since early 2020. But it has stayed roughly the same since September 2022, when 72% said this.

Majorities of adults in both parties say their side is losing more often than winning. Today, about eight-in-ten Republicans and Republican-leaning independents (83%) say this – little changed since 2022.

However, when Donald Trump was president, more Republicans thought their side was winning. In February 2020, 69% of Republicans said their side was winning more often than losing, while just 29% said it was mostly losing.

Just a quarter of Americans feel like their side is 'winning' in politics

% who say that in politics, their side has been ___ on the issues that matter to them



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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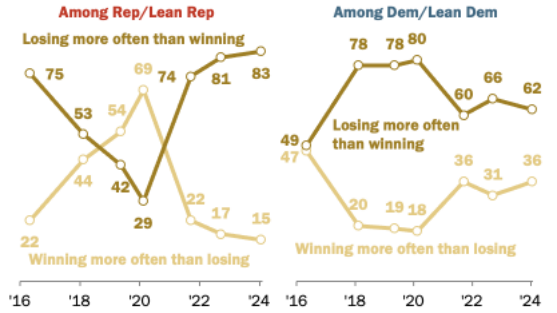
1 Americans are split over the state of the American dream

Democrats, who currently control the White House, are more positive than Republicans about their political standing.

Still, about six-in-ten Democrats and Democratic leaners (62%) say their side is losing more than winning on the issues that matter to them. This is slightly lower than the 66% who said this in 2022.

Majorities of Republicans and Democrats continue to say their side in politics has been losing

% who say that in politics, their side has been ___ on the issues that matter to them



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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In early 2020, and at earlier points in Trump's presidency, much larger majorities of Democrats said they felt like their side was losing more than winning. For example, 80% of Democrats said this in February 2020.

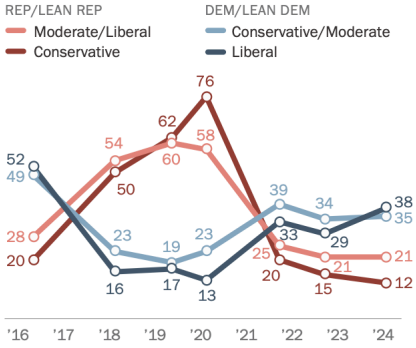
Ideological differences

Democrats

- Today, about four-in-ten liberal Democrats (38%) say their side is winning more often than losing, up from 29% who said the same in 2022.
- About a third of conservative and moderate Democrats (35%) say their side is winning more often than losing, nearly identical to the 34% who said this in 2022.
- Both groups of Democrats are more positive about how their side is doing politically than they were during the Trump administration, but less positive than they were at the end of Barack Obama's presidency.

Most conservative Republicans said they were 'winning' under Trump; fewer liberal Democrats feel that way today

% of ___ who say that in politics, their side has been ***winning more often than losing***



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Republicans

- Today, just 12% of conservative Republicans say their side has been winning more often than losing on the issues that matter to them. This is little changed from the 15% who said the same in 2022, but down from 76% in 2020, during Trump's presidency.
- About two-in-ten moderate and liberal Republicans (21%) currently say they have been winning more often than losing – identical to the share who said this in 2022. In 2020, by comparison, a 58% majority of these Republicans said their side was winning more than losing.
- Views among both ideological groups of Republicans are roughly similar to what they were in 2016, when Obama was president.

Note: Here are the questions used for this analysis and its methodology. This is an update of a post originally published on Oct. 3, 2022.

Topics Partisanship & Issues, Political Parties, Political Parties & Polarization, Politics & Policy

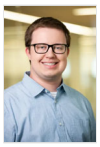
2 Majorities of LGBTQ and non-LGBTQ U.S. adults under 50 want to get married someday

3 Online Scams and Attacks in America Today

4 Gender pay gap in U.S. has narrowed slightly over 2 decades

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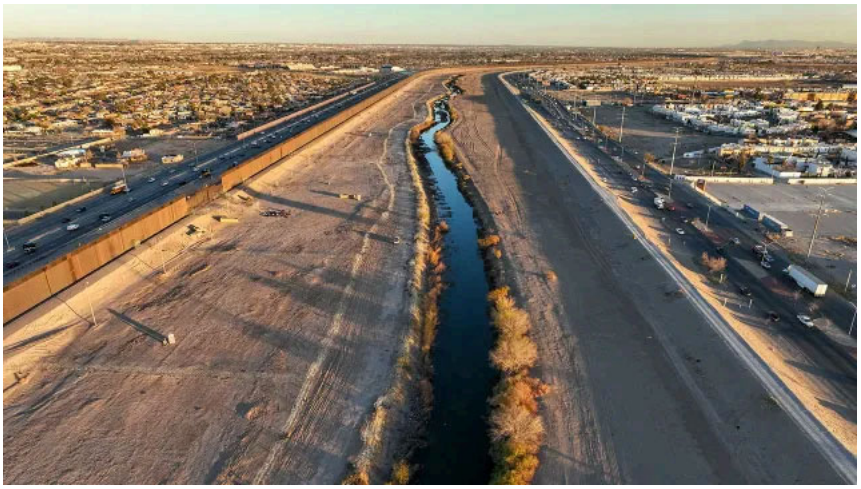
REPORT | FEBRUARY 15, 2024

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How Americans View the Situation at the U.S.-Mexico Border, Its Causes and Consequences

80% say the U.S. government is doing a bad job handling the migrant influx

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A view of the U.S.-Mexico border wall from Feb. 1, 2024. (Lokman Vural Elibol/Anadolu via Getty Images)

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand the public's views about the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16-21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for the report and its methodology.

The growing number of migrants seeking entry into the United States at its border with Mexico has strained government resources, divided Congress and emerged as a

REPORT MATERIALS

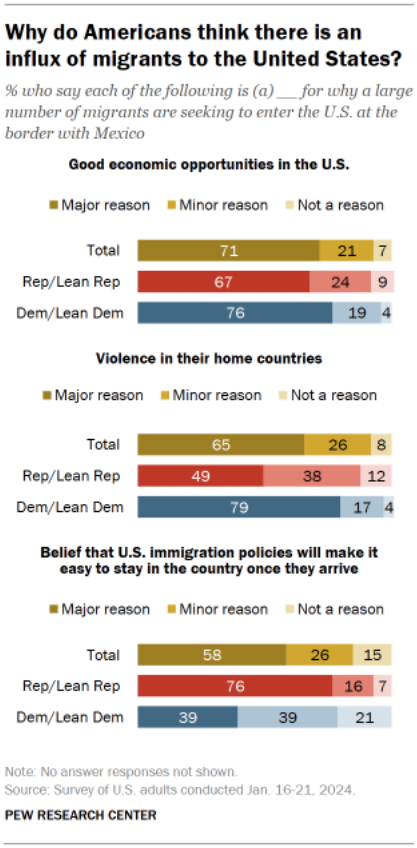
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Topline

American Trends Panel Wave 140

contentious issue in the 2024 presidential campaign.

Americans overwhelmingly fault the government for how it has handled the migrant situation. Beyond that, however, there are deep differences – over why the migrants are coming to the U.S., proposals for addressing the situation, and even whether it should be described as a "crisis."



Factors behind the migrant influx

Economic factors – **either poor conditions in migrants' home countries or better economic opportunities in the United States** – are widely viewed as major reasons for the migrant influx.

About seven-in-ten Americans (71%), including majorities in both parties, cite better economic opportunities in the U.S. as a major reason.

There are wider partisan differences over other factors.

About two-thirds of Americans (65%) say **violence in migrants' home countries** is a major reason for why a large number of immigrants have come to the border.

Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents are 30 percentage points more likely than Republicans and Republican leaners to cite this as a major reason (79% vs. 49%).

By contrast, 76% of Republicans say **the belief that U.S. immigration policies will make it easy to stay in the country once they arrive** is a major factor. About half as many Democrats (39%) say the same.

For more on Americans' views of these and other reasons, visit Chapter 2.

How serious is the situation at the border?

A sizable majority of Americans (78%) say the large number of migrants seeking to enter this country at the U.S.-Mexico border is either a crisis (45%) or a major problem (32%), according to the Pew Research Center survey, conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024, among 5,140 adults.

Related: *Migrant encounters at the U.S.-Mexico border hit a record high at the end of 2023.*

- Republicans are much more likely than Democrats to **describe the situation as a "crisis":** 70% of Republicans say this, compared with just 22% of Democrats.
- Democrats mostly **view the situation as a major problem** (44%) or minor problem (26%) for the U.S. Very few Democrats (7%) say it is not a problem.

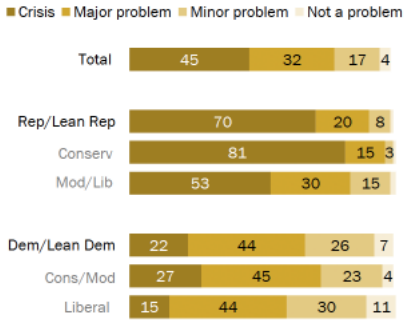
In an open-ended question, respondents voice their concerns about the migrant influx. They point to numerous issues, including worries about how the migrants are cared for and general problems with the immigration system.

Yet two concerns come up most frequently:

- 22% point to the **economic burdens** associated with the migrant influx, including the strains migrants place on social services and other government resources.
- 22% also cite **security concerns.** Many of these responses focus on crime (10%), terrorism (10%) and drugs (3%).

Border situation viewed as a 'crisis' by most Republicans; Democrats are more likely to call it a 'problem'

% who say the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico is (a) ...



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.
PEW RESEARCH CENTER

When asked specifically about the impact of the migrant influx on crime in the United States, a majority of Americans (57%) say **the large number of migrants seeking to enter the country leads to more crime.** Fewer (39%) say this does not have much of an impact on crime in this country.

Republicans (85%) overwhelmingly say the migrant surge leads to increased crime in the U.S. A far smaller share of Democrats (31%) say the same; 63% of Democrats instead say it does not have much of an impact.

Government widely criticized for its handling of migrant influx

For the past several years, the federal government has gotten low ratings for its handling of the situation at the U.S.-Mexico border. *(Note: The wording of this question has been modified modestly to reflect circumstances at the time).*

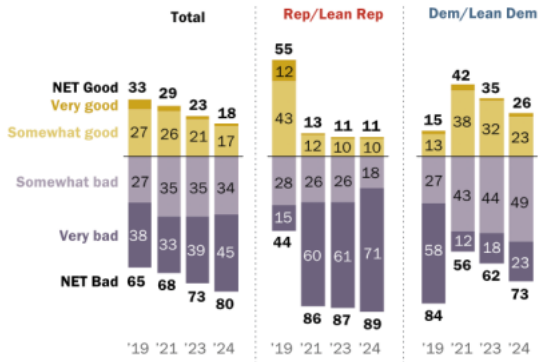
However, the current ratings are extraordinarily low.

Just 18% say the U.S. government is doing a good job dealing with the large number of migrants at the border, while 80% say it is doing a bad job, including 45% who say it is doing a *very bad* job.

- Republicans' views are overwhelmingly negative (89% say it's doing a bad job), as they have been since Joe Biden became president.
- 73% of Democrats also give the government negative ratings, the highest share recorded during Biden's presidency.

Only about a quarter of Democrats and even fewer Republicans say the government has done a good job dealing with large number of migrants at the border

% who say the U.S. government is doing a ___ job dealing with the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico



Note: No answer responses not shown. Surveys conducted in 2023 and prior were worded slightly differently than in 2024. Refer to the Topline for full question wording.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.
PEW RESEARCH CENTER

For more on Americans' evaluations of the situation, visit Chapter 1.

Which policies could improve the border situation?

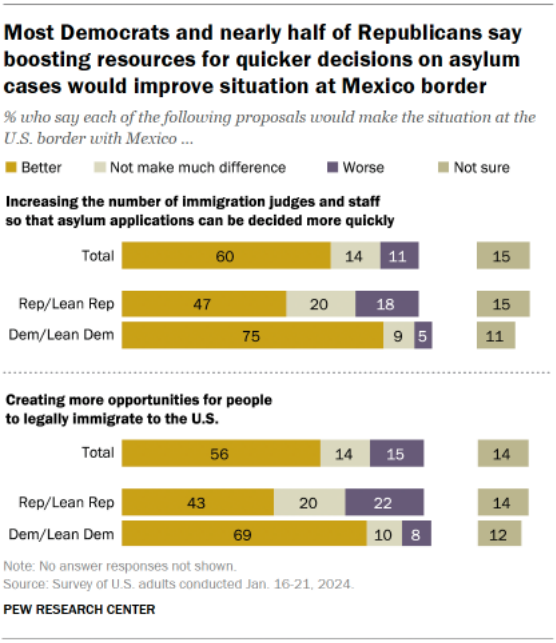
There is no single policy proposal, among the nine included on the survey, that majorities of both Republicans and Democrats say would improve the situation at the U.S.-Mexico border. There are areas of *relative* agreement, however.

A 60% majority of Americans say that **increasing the number of immigration judges and staff in order to make decisions on asylum more quickly** would make the situation better. Only 11% say it would make things worse, while 14% think it would not make much difference.

Nearly as many (56%) say **creating more opportunities for people to legally immigrate to the U.S.** would make the situation better.

Majorities of Democrats say each of these proposals would make the border situation better.

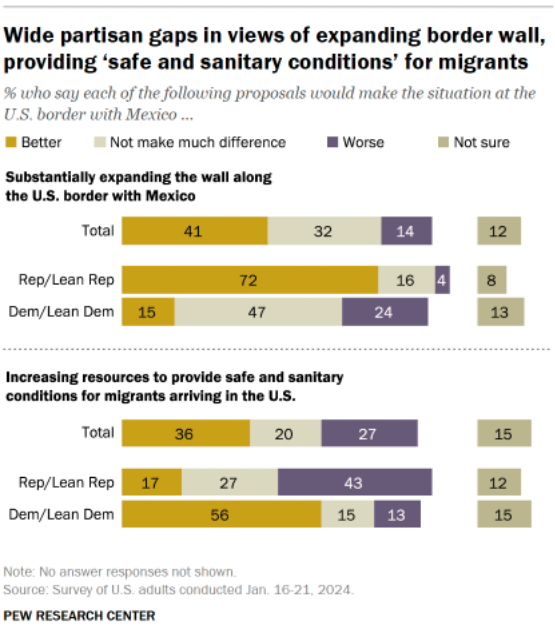
Republicans are less positive than are Democrats; still, about 40% or more of Republicans say each would improve the situation, while far fewer say they would make things worse.



Opinions on other proposals are more polarized. For example, a 56% majority of Democrats say that **adding resources to provide safe and sanitary conditions for migrants arriving in the U.S.** would be a positive step forward.

Republicans not only are far less likely than Democrats to view this proposal positively, but far more say it would make the situation worse (43%) than better (17%).

Building or expanding a wall along the U.S.-Mexico border was among the most divisive policies of Donald Trump's presidency. In 2019, 82% of Republicans favored expanding the border wall, compared with just 6% of Democrats.



Today, 72% of Republicans say **substantially expanding the wall along the U.S. border with Mexico** would make the situation better. Just 15% of Democrats concur, with most saying either it would not make much of a difference (47%) or it would make things worse (24%).

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3. What would improve the U.S. immigration system?

4. In their own words: Americans' concerns, feelings about U.S.-Mexico border situation

Acknowledgments

Methodology

For more on Americans' reactions to policy proposals, visit Chapter 3.

Next: How Americans view the U.S.-Mexico border situation and the government's handling of the issue

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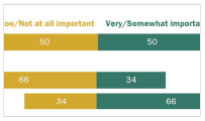
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SHORT READS | FEBRUARY 14, 2025

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Most Americans say it would be 'too risky' to give presidents, including Trump, more power

BY GABRIEL BORELLI



President Donald Trump signs an executive order in the Oval Office on Feb. 10, 2025. (Andrew Caballero-Reynolds/AFP via Getty Images)

In his first few weeks in office, President Donald Trump has moved quickly to assert – and attempt to expand – the power of the presidency. He has issued a record number of early-term executive orders and taken accompanying actions, many of which face legal challenges.

But a new Pew Research Center survey finds that Americans are skeptical about expanding the scope of presidential powers – both for Trump specifically and for presidents in general:

- 65% of U.S. adults say it would be "too risky" to give Trump more power to deal directly with many of the nation's problems. Just 33% take the view that "many of the country's problems could be dealt with more effectively if Trump didn't have to worry so much about Congress or the courts."
- Even more Americans – 78% – express concerns about expanding presidential power when asked about U.S. presidents in general.

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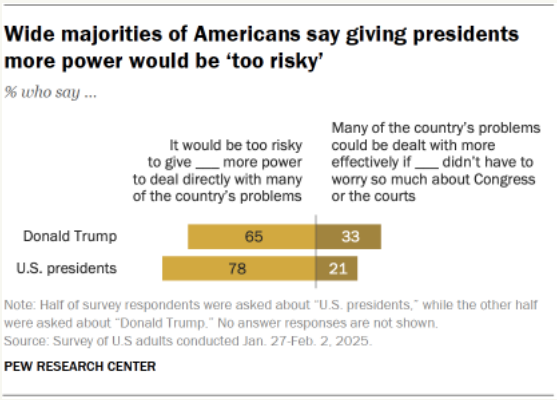
1 Americans are split over the state of the American dream

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this analysis to understand how the public views the prospect of expanded presidential power.

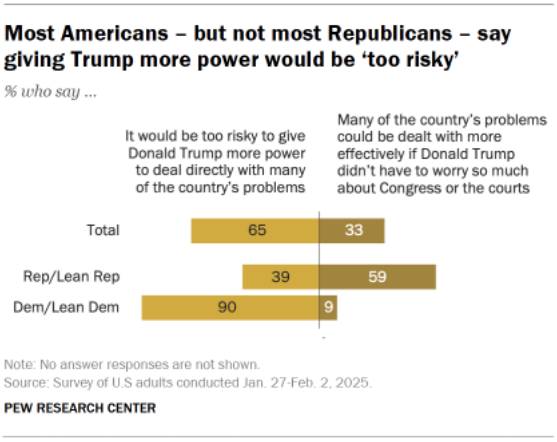
For this analysis, we surveyed 5,086 adults from Jan. 27 to Feb. 2, 2025. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.



Would it be 'too risky' to expand Trump's presidential powers?

An overwhelming majority of Democrats and Democratic leaners (90%) view the prospect of expanding Trump's presidential power as too risky.



In contrast, a 59% majority of Republicans and Republican-leaning independents say many of the country's problems could be addressed more effectively if Trump didn't need to worry so much about Congress or the courts.

Republicans who say they "strongly" identify with the GOP are particularly likely to say the nation's problems could be more effectively addressed by giving Trump more power: 78% say this. This compares with about half of both Republicans who less strongly identify with the party (46%) and independents who lean Republican (47%).

Note: This survey was conducted from Jan. 27 to Feb. 2, before some of the Trump administration's most recent executive actions aimed at reducing the size of the federal workforce.

Would it be 'too risky' to expand the powers of the presidency in general?

In general, majorities of both Republicans and Democrats are skeptical about giving U.S. presidents more power. However, their opinions tend to shift depending on which party controls the presidency.

Republicans are now less likely to see expanded presidential power negatively than they were last year. When Democrat Joe Biden was president, more than three-quarters of Republicans said it would be too risky to expand presidential power.

2 Majorities of LGBTQ and non-LGBTQ U.S. adults under 50 want to get married someday

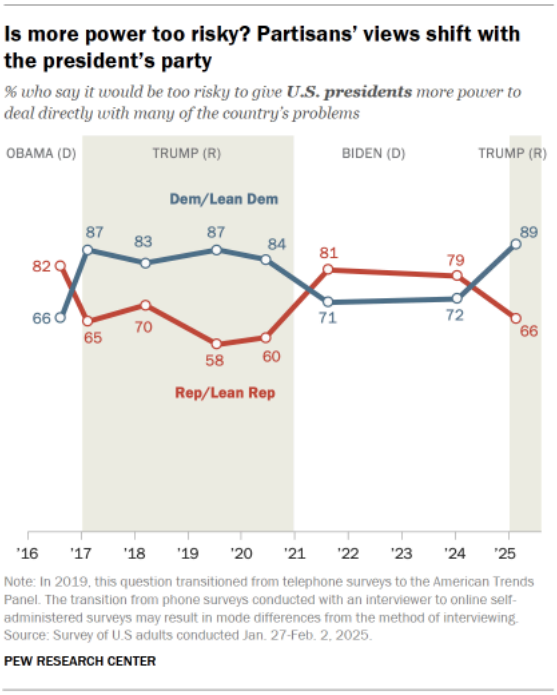
3 Online Scams and Attacks in America Today

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Currently, 66% say giving U.S. presidents more power would be too risky. This is similar to the shares who said this throughout much of Trump’s first term.

Democrats’ views have moved in the opposite direction. Today, 89% say it’s too risky to give presidents more power. That is on par with Democrats’ views during Trump’s first term, but up 17 percentage points from last year (during Biden’s presidency).



Note: This is an update of a post originally published on Feb. 28, 2024. Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.

Topics Federal Government, Politics & Policy, Trust in Government

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Gabriel Borelli is a research associate focusing on U.S. politics and policy at Pew Research Center.

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REPORT | FEBRUARY 29, 2024

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Americans' Top Policy Priority for 2024: Strengthening the Economy

Growing shares of Republicans rate immigration and terrorism as top priorities

TABLE OF CONTENTS +

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand the American public's views as the most important priorities for the president and Congress to prioritize in the coming year. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16-21, 2024.

Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for the report and its methodology.

As President Joe Biden prepares to deliver his third State of the Union address on March 7, Americans view strengthening the economy as the top policy priority for Biden and Congress to address this year.

The public's to-do list is little changed from the past two years, though it differs greatly from 2021, when dealing with the coronavirus ranked nearly as high as strengthening the economy on the policy agenda.

These are among the highlights of Pew Research Center's annual policy priorities survey, conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024, among 5,140 adults:

No single issue stands out after the economy. Nearly three-quarters of Americans (73%) rate strengthening the economy as a top priority. That is considerably larger than the shares citing any other policy goal.

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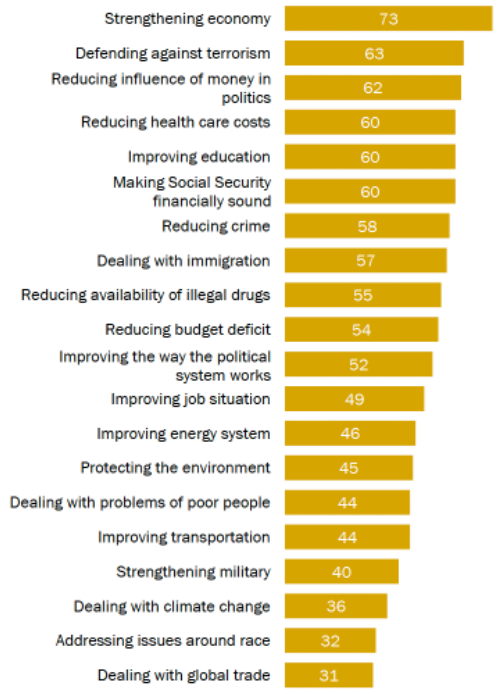
American Trends Panel Wave 140

Republicans are increasingly concerned over immigration. Over the course of Biden's presidency, the share of Americans citing immigration as a top priority has increased 18 percentage points – from 39% to 57% – with the change coming almost entirely among Republicans and Republican-leaning independents. Republicans have also grown more concerned over terrorism, especially in the past year.

Related: *How Americans View the Situation at the U.S.-Mexico Border, Its Causes and Consequences*

Americans' top policy priority this year? Strengthening the economy

% who say ___ should be a top priority for the president and Congress to address this year



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Crime is also a growing concern among Republicans. Nearly seven-in-ten Republicans and Republican leaners (68%) and 47% of Democrats and Democratic leaners say reducing crime should be a top policy priority. GOP concerns have risen steadily each year since 2021. Democratic views have been stable over the last few years after rising between 2021 and 2022.

There is bipartisan support for reducing the influence of money in politics. About six-in-ten Americans (62%) say reducing the influence of money in politics should be a top goal for the president and Congress. While there are wide partisan differences on most policy goals, 65% of Democrats and 60% of Republicans rate this as a top priority.

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Ongoing concerns: The economy, budget deficit and job situation

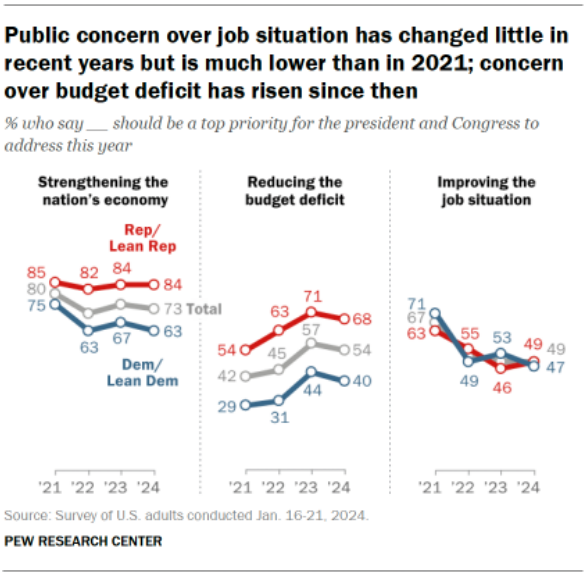
Large shares of Republicans and Republican-leaning independents (84%) and Democrats and Democratic leaners (63%) view **strengthening the nation's economy** as a top priority this year, as they have for the past several years.

And while more Americans say **the budget deficit** is a top priority now than did when Biden first took office in 2021, their views are similar compared with last year (54% now vs. 57% then).

Republicans (68%) remain more concerned about the deficit than Democrats (40%).

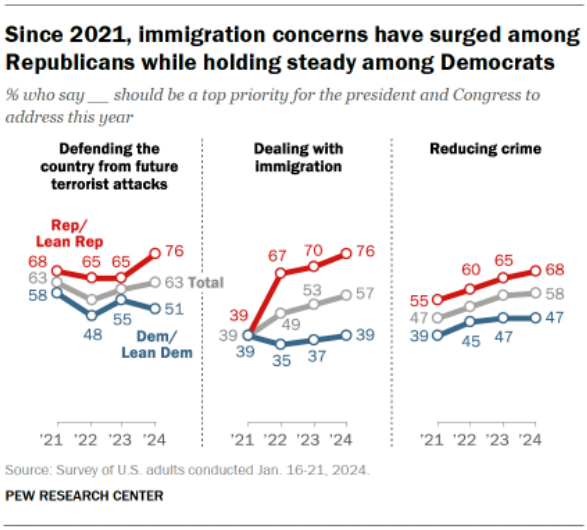
By comparison, about half of the public (49%) – including nearly identical shares in both parties – view **improving the job situation** as a top priority. Concerns over the job situation have declined sharply since 2021, during Biden's first year in office and when the coronavirus pandemic was ravaging the country.

Growing concerns: National security, crime and immigration



About six-in-ten Americans view defending the country from future terror attacks (63%), dealing with immigration (57%) and reducing crime (58%) as top political priorities for the upcoming year. And while Americans' overall views of these policy areas are largely unchanged over the past year, Republicans are more concerned than Democrats about each.

Terrorism



Among Republicans, concern about terrorism has risen 11 percentage points since last year (76% vs. 65%).

By comparison, about half of Democrats (51%) also view terrorism as a top priority this year (55% did so last year).

Immigration

Between 2021 and 2022, the share of Republicans citing immigration as a top policy priority rose sharply, from 39% to 67%.

Since then, it increased another 9 points, to 76%. Over this period, Democrats' views have been fairly stable; today, 39% rate dealing with immigration as a top priority.

Reducing crime

While reducing crime has changed little as a priority since last year, both parties have become more concerned about it since the start of Biden's presidency.

About seven-in-ten Republicans (68%) rate crime reduction as a top political priority, up 13 points since 2021. And roughly half of Democrats (47%) do the same (up 8 points over this period).

Wide partisan differences over most policy goals

Although majorities in both major parties share several top priorities – such as strengthening the economy, reducing the role of money in politics and ensuring Social

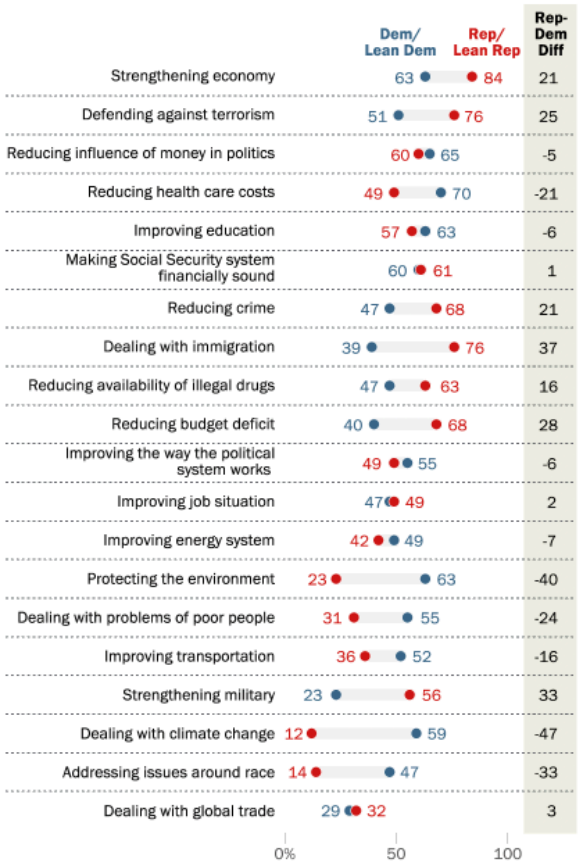
Security is financially sound – there are large differences on others.

For instance, Democrats are substantially more likely than Republicans to prioritize protecting the environment (63% vs. 23%) and dealing with climate change (59% vs. 12%).

By comparison, Republicans are much more likely to prioritize dealing with immigration (76% vs. 39%) and strengthening the military (56% vs. 23).

Top priorities for Republicans are the economy, terrorism and immigration; for Democrats, health care costs, the economy, education and the environment

% who say ___ should be a top priority for the president and Congress to address this year



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Differences by race and ethnicity

Clear majorities across racial and ethnic groups – about three-quarters each – view strengthening the economy as a top political priority this year.

They also uniformly prioritize defending the country against terrorism and reducing the influence of money in politics.

On other issues, differences are starker:

- While 41% of White adults prioritize improving the job situation, six-in-ten or more Black (64%), Hispanic (65%) and Asian Americans (62%) do the same.
- White and Asian adults (38% each) are far less likely than Hispanic (51%) and Black adults (70%) to prioritize dealing with problems of the poor.
- Black adults (65%) are substantially more likely to prioritize addressing issues around race than Hispanic (42%), Asian (32%) or White adults (23%).

Policy priorities by age

Similar shares of younger and older Americans view several issues as top priorities.

Across all age groups, about six-in-ten say reducing health care costs and improving education should be top political priorities this year.

But older Americans are particularly likely to prioritize some issues.

For example, nearly nine-in-ten people 65 and older (87%) and about three-quarters (76%) of those 50 to 64 say defending against terrorism should be a top priority. This drops to 55% of Americans 30 to 49 and 35% of those 18 to 29.

A similar pattern plays out for ensuring Social Security is financially sound, dealing with immigration, reducing the availability of illegal drugs and strengthening the military.

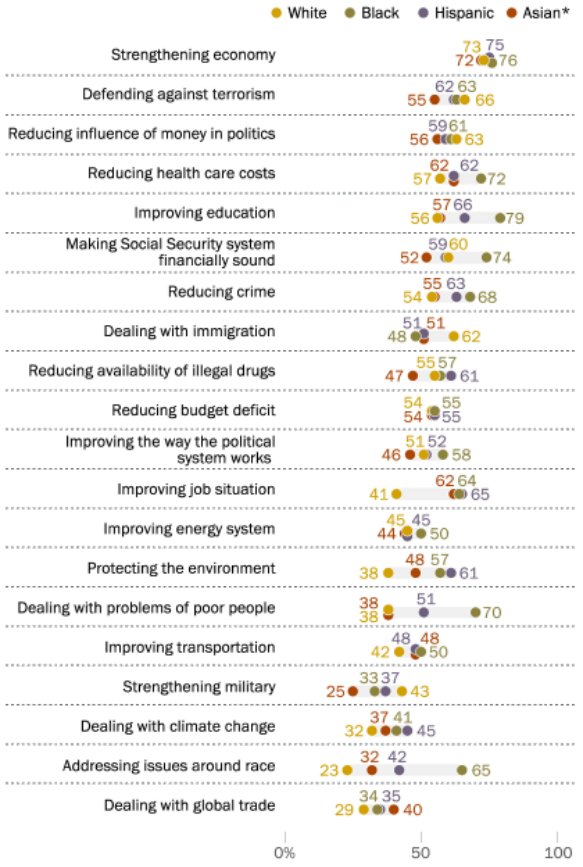
Few say policy objectives should not be pursued

Despite wide differences over whether certain issues should be a *top* priority, relatively few say any of the issues asked about should *not* be prioritized by the president and Congress this year.

For all but three issues surveyed, few Americans (3% or less) say these policy areas should not be pursued. The exceptions are dealing with climate change (12%), strengthening the military (8%) and addressing issues around race (7%).

Racial and ethnic differences in views of top policy priorities for the president and Congress

% who say ___ should be a top priority for the president and Congress to address this year



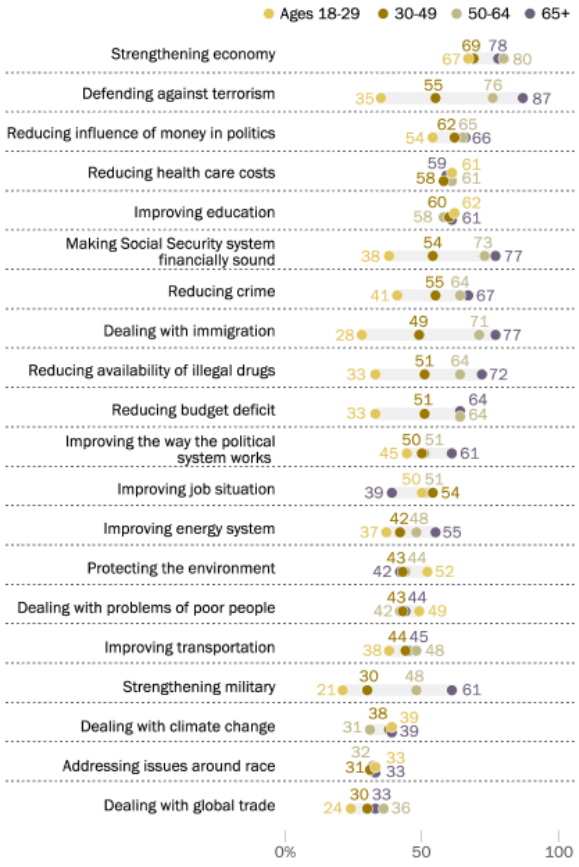
* Estimates for Asian adults are representative of English speakers only.
Note: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Similarly, relatively few say any of the policy areas are "not too important" to be addressed this year (at most, about a quarter say this for the same three policy issues).

Young adults are less likely to rate many issues as top priorities, including terrorism and immigration

% who say ___ should be a top priority for the president and Congress to address this year



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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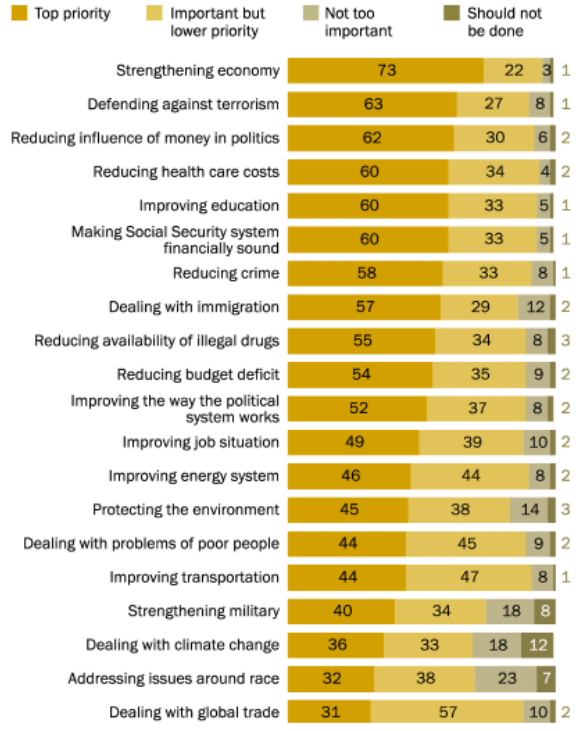
Few say policy objectives should not be pursued

Acknowledgments

Methodology

Majorities of Americans say all objectives are either a 'top priority' or 'important but lower priority'

% who say each of the following should be a(n) ___ for the president and Congress to address this year



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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SHORT READS | MARCH 12, 2024

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Majorities of adults see decline of union membership as bad for the U.S. and working people

BY TED VAN GREEN

Majorities of Americans see the large reduction in the share of workers represented by unions over the past several decades as a bad thing for both the country and working people in the United States.

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this analysis to measure Americans' views of the decline in U.S. union membership in recent decades. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024.

Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

- 54% of U.S. adults say the decline has been **bad for the country**.
- 59% say this has been **bad for working people**.

The share of U.S. workers who belong to a union has fallen since 1983, when 20.1% of American workers were union members. In 2023, 10.0% of U.S. workers were in a union.

Views about the decline in union membership have changed only modestly since last year, when 58% said it was bad for the country. There has been no change in views about its impact on working people.

There are modest demographic differences in the perceived impacts of the decline in union membership. However, **partisan differences are much more pronounced**, according to a Pew Research Center survey conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024:

- About seven-in-ten Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents (69%) say the decline in the percentage of workers represented by unions has been very or somewhat bad for the country. About three-quarters (74%) say it has been bad for working people.

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- Among Republicans and GOP leaners, 40% say the decline of organized labor has been bad for the country, and 43% say it has been bad for working people.

Demographic differences within the parties

Among Republicans

There are sizable age, educational and income gaps in GOP views about the impact of union membership decline **on working people**. (The patterns are very similar when it comes to views about its impact on the country.)

- 71% of Republicans ages 65 and older say the decline of unions has been very or somewhat *good* for working people, compared with 40% of adults under age 40.
- Upper-income Republicans (66%) are more likely than their counterparts in the middle-income (57%) and lower-income (46%) tiers to say this.
- A majority of White Republicans (59%) say the decline of union membership has been at least somewhat good for working people. The sample sizes for Hispanic, Black and Asian Republicans are too small to analyze separately.

Among Democrats

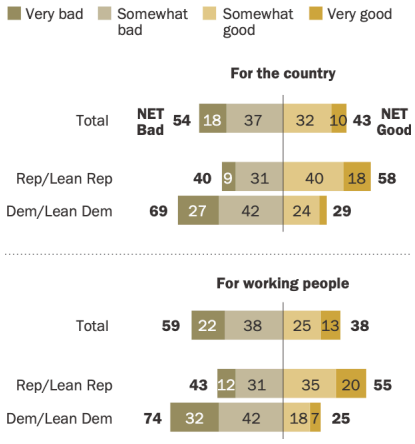
No more than four-in-ten Democrats across demographic groups see the decline in organized labor as good for working people. However, there are some differences by education level, income, and race and ethnicity:

- Democrats without a college degree are 13 percentage points more likely than those with a college degree to say the decline in union membership has been good for working people (30% vs. 17%).
- Democrats with lower incomes (31%) are more likely than middle-income (23%) and upper-income (17%) Democrats to say this.
- White Democrats (18%) are less likely than Black (37%) or Hispanic (32%) Democrats to say the decline in unionization has been good for working people. About a quarter of Asian Democrats (26%) say this.
- There are no substantial differences among Democrats by age.

Ideological differences

Majority of Americans say decline in the share of unionized workers has been bad for the U.S.

% who say the large reduction in the percentage of workers represented by unions has been ...

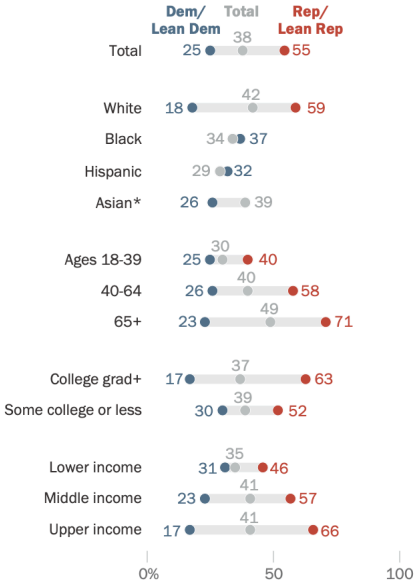


Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Americans differ by party – and within party – over the impact of declining union membership on working people

*% who say the large reduction in the percentage of workers represented by unions has been **very or somewhat good for working people***



* Estimates for Asian adults are representative of English speakers only.
Note: White and Black adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race. Family income tiers are based on adjusted 2021 earnings. Sample sizes for Black and Hispanic Rep/Lean Rep are too small to analyze separately.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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5 Google users are less likely to click on links when an AI summary appears in the results

While Republicans and Democrats differ greatly on whether these shifts have been good for working people, ideological differences are also evident within both parties.

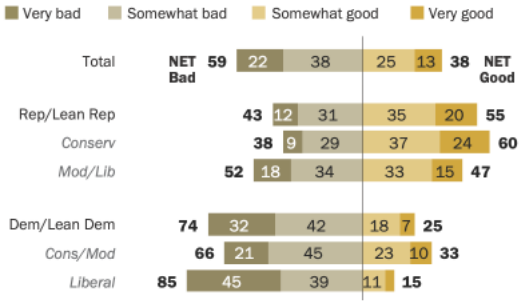
Among Republicans

A majority of conservative Republicans (60%) say the decline in organized labor membership has been at least somewhat good for working people, including 24% who say this has been very good.

In contrast, moderate and liberal Republicans are split: 47% say this has been at least somewhat good for working people, while 52% say it has been at least somewhat bad.

Conservative Republicans are far more likely than GOP moderates and liberals to view the decline of union membership as good for working people

% who say the large reduction in the percentage of workers represented by unions has been ____ for working people



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Among Democrats

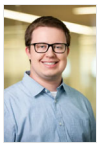
Across ideological groups, large majorities of Democrats say the decline in the percentage of workers represented by unions has been *bad* for working people. But liberal Democrats (85%) are more likely than conservative and moderate Democrats (66%) to say this.

Liberal Democrats are particularly likely to say the decline in organized labor has been *very bad* for working people: 45% say this, compared with 21% of conservative and moderate Democrats.

Note: This is an update of a post originally published on Feb. 18, 2022, and updated on April 19, 2023. Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

Topics Business & Workplace, Economy & Work, Employee Benefits, Partisanship & Issues, Unions

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REPORT | MARCH 26, 2024

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Most Americans Favor Legalizing Marijuana for Medical, Recreational Use

Legalizing recreational marijuana viewed as good for local economies; mixed views of impact on drug use, community safety

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How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand the public's views about the legalization of marijuana in the United States. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for the report and its methodology.

As more states pass laws legalizing marijuana for recreational use, Americans continue to favor legalization of both medical and recreational use of the drug.

An overwhelming share of U.S. adults (88%) say marijuana **should be legal for medical or recreational use.**

Nearly six-in-ten Americans (57%) say that marijuana should be legal for medical *and* recreational purposes, while roughly a third (32%) say that marijuana should be legal for medical use only.

Just 11% of Americans say that the drug **should not be legal at all.**

Opinions about marijuana legalization have changed little over the past five years, according to the Pew Research Center survey, conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024, among 5,140 adults.

The impact of legalizing marijuana for recreational use

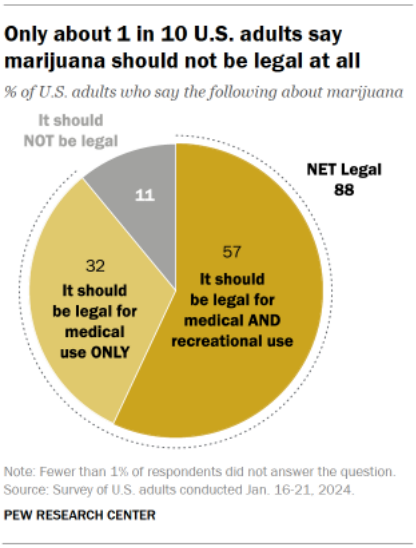
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American Trends Panel Wave 140

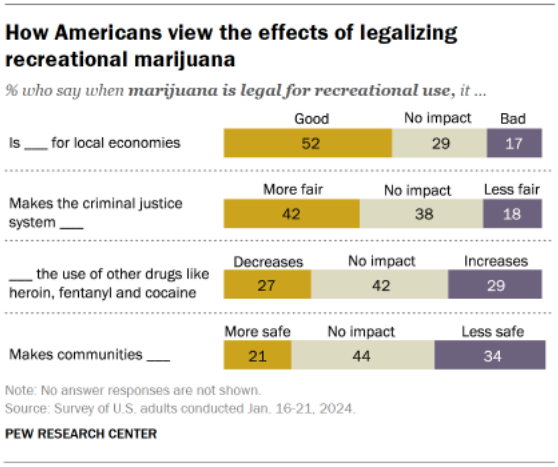
While a majority of Americans continue to say marijuana should be legal, there are **varying views about the impacts of recreational legalization.**



About half of Americans (52%) say that legalizing the recreational use of marijuana is **good for local economies;** just 17% think it is bad and 29% say it has no impact.

More adults also say legalizing marijuana for recreational use makes the **criminal justice system more fair** (42%) than less fair (18%); 38% say it has no impact.

However, Americans have mixed views on the impact of legalizing marijuana for recreational use on:



- **Use of other drugs:** About as many say it increases (29%) as say it decreases (27%) the use of other drugs, like heroin, fentanyl and cocaine (42% say it has no impact).
- **Community safety:** More Americans say legalizing recreational marijuana makes communities less safe (34%) than say it makes them safer (21%); 44% say it has no impact.

Partisan differences on impact of recreational use of marijuana

There are deep partisan divisions regarding the impact of marijuana legalization for recreational use.

Majorities of Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents say legalizing recreational marijuana is good for local economies (64% say this) and makes the criminal justice system fairer (58%).

Fewer Republicans and Republican leaners say legalization for recreational use has a positive effect on local economies (41%) and the criminal justice system (27%).

Republicans are more likely than Democrats to cite **downsides from legalizing recreational marijuana:**

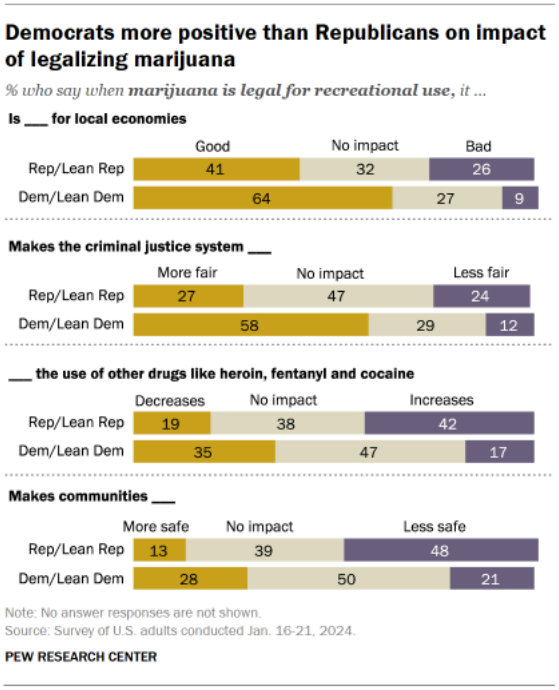
- 42% of Republicans say it increases the use of other drugs, like heroin, fentanyl and cocaine, compared with just 17% of Democrats.
- 48% of Republicans say it makes communities less safe, more than double the share of Democrats (21%) who say this.

Demographic, partisan differences in views of marijuana legalization

Sizable age and partisan differences persist on the issue of marijuana legalization though **small shares of adults across demographic groups are completely opposed to it.**

Older adults are far less likely than younger adults to favor marijuana legalization.

This is particularly the case among adults ages 75 and older: 31% say marijuana should be legal for both medical and recreational use.

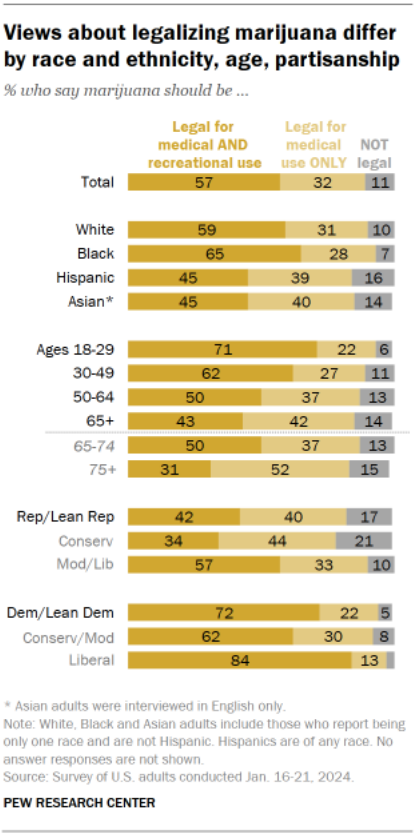


By comparison, half of adults between the ages of 65 and 74 say marijuana should be legal for medical and recreational use, and larger shares in younger age groups say the same.

Republicans continue to be less supportive than Democrats of legalizing marijuana for both legal and recreational use: 42% of Republicans favor legalizing marijuana for both purposes, compared with 72% of Democrats.

There continue to be **ideological differences within each party:**

- 34% of conservative Republicans say marijuana should be legal for medical and recreational use, compared with a 57% majority of moderate and liberal Republicans.
- 62% of conservative and moderate Democrats say marijuana should be legal for medical and recreational use, while an overwhelming majority of liberal Democrats (84%) say this.



Views of marijuana legalization vary by age within both parties

Along with differences by party and age, there are also **age differences *within* each party** on the issue.

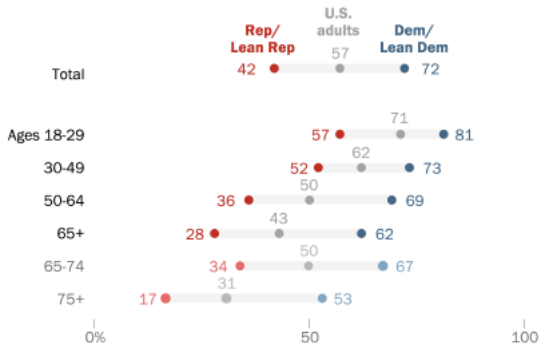
A 57% majority of Republicans ages 18 to 29 favor making marijuana legal for medical and recreational use, compared with 52% among those ages 30 to 49 and much smaller shares of older Republicans.

Still, **wide majorities of Republicans in all age groups favor legalizing marijuana at least for medical use.** Among those ages 65 and older, just 20% say marijuana should not be legal even for medical purposes.

While majorities of Democrats across all age groups support legalizing marijuana for medical and recreational use, older Democrats are less likely to say this.

Large age differences in both parties in views of legalizing marijuana for medical and recreational use

% who say marijuana should be legal for medical AND recreational use



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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About half of Democrats ages 75 and older (53%) say marijuana should be legal for both purposes, but much larger shares of younger Democrats say the same (including 81% of Democrats ages 18 to 29). Still, only 7% of Democrats ages 65 and older think marijuana should not be legalized even for medical use, similar to the share of all other Democrats who say this.

Views of the effects of legalizing recreational marijuana among racial and ethnic groups

Substantial shares of Americans across racial and ethnic groups say when marijuana is legal for recreational use, it has a more positive than negative impact on the economy and criminal justice system.

Economy

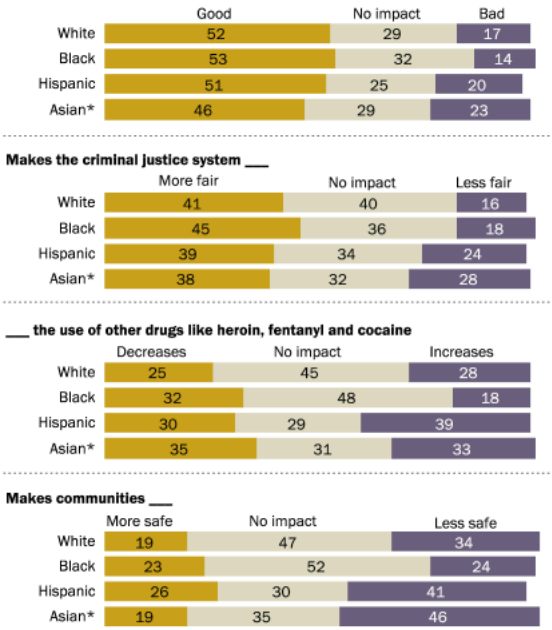
About half of White (52%), Black (53%) and Hispanic (51%) adults say legalizing recreational marijuana is good for local economies. A slightly smaller share of Asian adults (46%) say the same.

Criminal justice

Across racial and ethnic groups, about four-in-ten say that recreational marijuana being legal makes the criminal justice system fairer, with smaller shares saying it would make it less fair.

Hispanic and Asian adults more likely than Black and White adults to say legalizing recreational marijuana negatively impacts safety, use of other drugs

*% who say **when marijuana is legal for recreational use**, it ...*



* Asian adults were interviewed in English only.

Note: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race. No answer responses are not shown.

Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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However, there are wider racial differences on questions regarding the impact of recreational marijuana on the use of other drugs and the safety of communities.

Use of other drugs

Nearly half of Black adults (48%) say recreational marijuana legalization doesn't have an effect on the use of drugs like heroin, fentanyl and cocaine. Another 32% in this group say it *decreases* the use of these drugs and 18% say it increases their use.

In contrast, Hispanic adults are slightly more likely to say legal marijuana *increases* the use of these other drugs (39%) than to say it decreases this use (30%); 29% say it has no impact.

Among White adults, the balance of opinion is mixed: 28% say marijuana legalization increases the use of other drugs and 25% say it decreases their use (45% say it has no impact). Views among Asian adults are also mixed, though a smaller share (31%) say legalization has no impact on the use of other drugs.

Community safety

Hispanic and Asian adults also are more likely to say marijuana's legalization makes communities less safe: 41% of Hispanic adults and 46% of Asian adults say this, compared with 34% of White adults and 24% of Black adults.

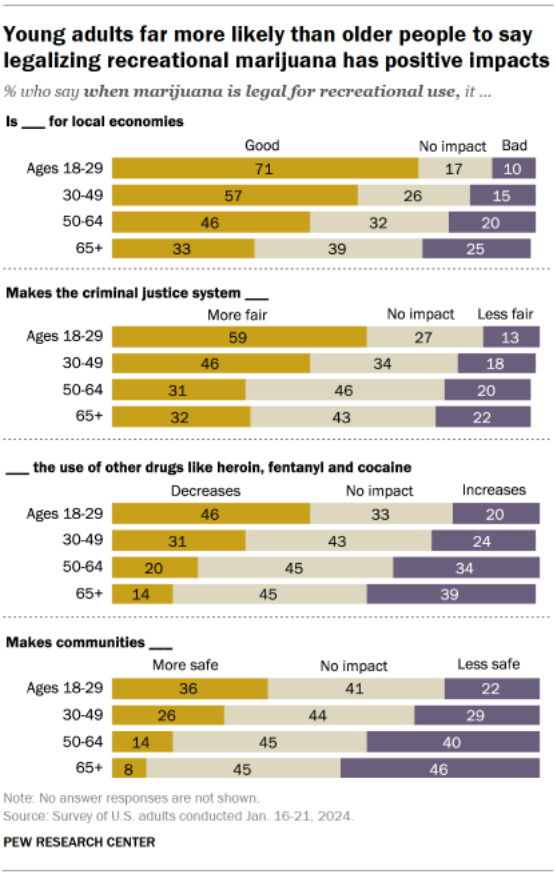
Wide age gap on views of impact of legalizing recreational marijuana

Young Americans view the legalization of marijuana for recreational use in more positive terms compared with their older counterparts.

Clear majorities of adults under 30 say it is good for local economies (71%) and that it makes the criminal justice system fairer (59%).

By comparison, a third of Americans ages 65 and older say legalizing the recreational use of marijuana is good for local economies; about as many (32%) say it makes the criminal justice system more fair.

There also are sizable differences in opinion by age about how legalizing recreational marijuana affects the use of other drugs and the safety of communities.



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